

Decade of Survival (1947–1958)

- 1947: Structural & Survival Crisis
- Management & Physical Dependency: Lack of administrative infrastructure and industries.
- Refugee Crisis: Massive influx of displaced populations.
- Legal Framework: Operated under the Government of India Act 1935 (with amendments) due to lack of a new constitution.
- 1948–1951: Leadership Vacuum
- Sept 11, 1948: Death of Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah.
- Oct 16, 1951: Assassination of Liaquat Ali Khan.
- 1950s: Socio-Economic Strain
- Severe food shortages and lack of

industrial output.

- **1956: Constitutional Milestone**
- First Constitution of Pakistan is finally passed.
- **1958: Political Collapse**
- The 1956 Constitution is **abrogated**; Martial Law is declared, ending the first phase.

Strategic Alignment (1954-1955)

Despite internal instability, Pakistan achieved a major foreign policy success by joining the **Western Bloc** to secure its borders and economy.

- **1954: SEATO Membership** – Pakistan joined the **Southeast Asia Treaty Organization**, signaling a formal alliance with the US to counter regional threats.
- **1955: CENTO Membership** – Further

strengthening its defense, Pakistan joined the Baghdad Pact (later CENTO).

Positive Impact:

- **Military Aid:** Modernization of the armed forces.
- **Economic Assistance:** Inflow of US aid to combat food shortages and support early infrastructure.
- **Diplomatic Weight:** Elevated Pakistan's status in international geopolitics.

The Ayub Khan Era: 1958–1969

1. Political Transition & Consolidation (1958)

The era began with the declaration of the

country's first **Military Regime**. General Ayub Khan consolidated power by arguing that Western-style democracy was unsuited to Pakistan's social fabric. He replaced the parliamentary system with a focus on:

- **Discipline and Modernization:** A shift toward technocratic planning rather than political debate.
- **Suppression of Opposition:** Implementing the **Elective Bodies Disqualification Order (EBDO)** to disqualify politicians and limiting civilian liberties to maintain "order."

2. Administrative Innovation:

Local Governance

To manage the country at the grassroots level, Ayub introduced the **Basic Democracies** system:

- A four-tier system of elected councils

at village and urban levels.

- Designed to resolve local administrative issues while serving as an electoral college for the Presidency, effectively bypassing direct national elections.

3. The 1962 Constitution

Ayub formalized his rule by introducing a new constitution:

- **Presidential Form of Government:** Concentrated executive power in the office of the President.
- **Unicameral Legislature:** A single-chamber system that limited the scope of political opposition and centralized decision-making.

4. Economic Strategy & The Green Revolution

The regime is famous for its "Decade of Development," driven by two main pillars:

- **Industrialization via PPP:** Building the industrial sector through **Public-Private Partnerships**, offering incentives to private investors to boost the national economy.
- **The Green Revolution:** Transforming the agricultural landscape by introducing **High-Yield Variety (HYV) seeds**, chemical fertilizers, and modern irrigation (tractors and tube wells), which significantly increased food output.

Foreign Policy

1. The Indus Waters Treaty (1960)

Brokered by the World Bank, this was a landmark water-sharing agreement that settled a volatile dispute between

Pakistan and India following partition.

- **The Split:** Pakistan gained exclusive rights to the three western rivers (Indus, Jhelum, and Chenab), while India received the three eastern rivers (Ravi, Beas, and Sutlej).
- **Significance:** It led to the construction of the Mangla and Tarbela dams and an extensive canal system, which became the backbone of Pakistan's "Green Revolution" in agriculture.

2. The Sino-Pakistan Boundary Agreement (1963)

This was the strategic move you mentioned involving the Shaksgam Valley.

- **The Trade:** Pakistan formally recognized Chinese sovereignty over the Shaksgam Valley (roughly 5,180 sq km). In return, China recognized Pakistan's control over parts of Gilgit-

Baltistan and adjusted the border in Pakistan's favor in other spots.

- **The Result:** This ended border tensions with China and laid the foundation for the "all-weather" friendship, eventually leading to the construction of the Karakoram Highway.

3. The 1965 Indo-Pakistani War

A full-scale conflict that broke out following **Operation Gibraltar**, Pakistan's attempt to spark an uprising in Kashmir.

- **The Conflict:** The war saw the largest tank battles since WWII. It ended in a stalemate after 17 days following a UN-mandated ceasefire.
- **The Diplomacy:** The war concluded with the **Tashkent Declaration** in 1966, mediated by the Soviet Union. While militarily a draw, the political fallout

in Pakistan weakened Ayub Khan's popularity and led to the rise of Zulfikar Ali Bhutto.

5. Major Criticisms & Failure of Equity

Despite high GDP growth, the era faced severe backlash due to:

- **Wealth Concentration:** The rise of the "22 Families" who controlled the vast majority (roughly 66%) of the nation's industrial and banking assets.
- **Social & Regional Inequality:** The benefits of growth did not reach the common man, and a growing economic gap emerged between East and West Pakistan.
- **Human Rights Concerns:** The lack of political freedom and the centralization of power eventually led

to widespread public unrest.